

Generative AI Acceptable Use Policy

Purpose and Scope

This AI Acceptable Use Policy ("Policy") governs the use of public artificial intelligence (AI) systems within The Bridgewater Company ("Organization"). It is designed to ensure the ethical, secure, and lawful use of AI technologies. This Policy applies to all employees, contractors, and affiliated parties who access Generative AI for business-related purposes.

User Responsibilities

Users of AI systems are required to:

- Adhere to all security protocols and ethical guidelines outlined in this Policy.
- Use AI systems solely for the intended business purposes as specified by the Organization.
- Maintain the confidentiality and integrity of data accessed through AI systems.

Prohibited Uses

The following uses of AI are strictly prohibited:

- Use of AI models and tools that have not been expressly approved for company use.
- Input of customer data such as account numbers, balances, transaction history, Social Security Numbers, credit reports, or anything else that could be used to identify a specific customer.
- Submission of data that has been only superficially masked or redacted and that still contains quasi-identifiers capable of re-identification.
- Input of unreleased business information such as draft financial statements, unreleased products, internal strategy documents, HR data, and compensation data.
- Input of proprietary source code, API keys, internal architecture diagrams, database schema and credentials.
- Input of regulatory or legal documents such as audits, examinations, legal proceedings or regulatory filings.
- Utilization of AI to create, distribute, or endorse fraudulent, deceptive, or misleading content.

Outputs and Intellectual Property

- Users must review all AI-generated content before use or distribution to identify potential copyright infringement, trademark issues, or other third-party rights.
- When AI is used to assist in creating material that will be published, shared externally, or commercialized, users must:
 - Disclose AI assistance where required by company policy, client agreements, or applicable law;
 - Ensure sufficient human contribution and review so the final work product is not solely AI-generated;
 - Obtain necessary licenses or clearances if the output appears to incorporate protected third-party content.
- Company ownership of any work-related product is governed by existing intellectual-property and employment agreements; use of AI does not alter those rules.

Data Governance

Users must:

- Access data in accordance with the Organization's data governance framework.
- Confirm a tool's approval status before use. The current list of approved AI tools is maintained by the IT Security Team and is available on the company intranet.
- Not share confidential data externally without explicit authorization.

Anonymization of Data

- Before submitting any data to an approved AI tool, users must ensure the data has been properly de-identified or anonymized in accordance with the Organization's Data Classification Policy and any applicable privacy or data-protection requirements.
 - Simple masking or redaction of direct identifiers (i.e., names, account numbers, Social Security Numbers) is not sufficient if residual data elements (unique transaction patterns, rare geographic codes, precise timestamps combined with amounts, etc.) could allow re-identification of an individual or entity.
 - Users must follow the de-identification standards and techniques defined in the Data Classification Policy (or consult the Data Privacy / IT Security team when in doubt).

Security Requirements

Users are required to:

- Ensure that all AI-enabled devices and applications are secure and protected against unauthorized access.
- Utilize encryption and other security measures to protect data confidentiality and integrity.
- Report any security incidents or vulnerabilities in AI systems to the IT security team immediately.

Usage Monitoring, Logging, and Enforcement

Approved Tooling and Logging Requirements

- All generative AI usage at The Bridgewater Company must occur through IT-sanctioned platforms (e.g., enterprise-licensed Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, or equivalent) that provide administrator-level audit logging. Use of unsanctioned or "shadow AI" tools (personal ChatGPT accounts, unmanaged browser extensions, unapproved APIs) is prohibited and constitutes a policy violation independent of any data exposure that may occur. Sanctioned platforms must log, at minimum:
 - User identity and timestamp of each session
 - Prompt and output metadata (not necessarily full content, depending on tool capability and privacy constraints)
 - File or data source attachments submitted to the AI tool

Data Loss Prevention (DLP) Controls

- AI tool usage is subject to existing DLP policy. Prompts containing customer PII, account numbers, non-public financial data, or other data classified as Confidential or Restricted under the Data Classification Policy are prohibited regardless of tool sanctioning status. Where technically feasible, DLP tooling should be configured to detect and block such data from being submitted to AI interfaces, consistent with controls applied to email and file-sharing channels.

Monitoring and Review Cadence

- IT Security will review AI usage logs on a monthly basis, or more frequently if triggered by a DLP alert or reported incident. Review will focus on:
 - Use of unsanctioned tools
 - Submission of restricted data categories
 - Volume/pattern anomalies (e.g., bulk data exports via AI prompts).

Violation Handling

- Detected violations are escalated to the employee's manager and IT Security within 2 business days. First-time inadvertent violations result in a documented coaching conversation and policy re-acknowledgment. Repeated or willful violations (e.g., knowing submission of restricted data, use of unsanctioned tools after warning) are handled under existing disciplinary policy and may result in access revocation.

Compliance and Legal Obligations

All AI use must comply with:

- Relevant laws and regulations, including data protection laws and intellectual property rights.
- Industry standards and best practices related to AI and cybersecurity.

Reporting and Consequences

- Any violation of this Policy must be reported to the IT Security team.
- Violations will be reviewed and may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment or contracts.

Review and Update Process

This Policy will be reviewed and updated on a semi-annual basis or as required by changes in law or technological advancements. Users will be notified of any changes to the Policy and are expected to comply with the updated terms.

By accessing and using AI resources for the purpose of business involving The Bridgewater Company, users acknowledge that they have read, understood, and agreed to comply with this Policy.